

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

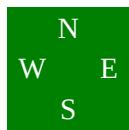
Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 7 3
♥ Q J 10 9
♦ 9 4 2
♣ Q 5 3

♠ K J 4 2
♥ K 5
♦ A K 6
♣ K 9 7 4



♠ 10 8 5
♥ A 6 2
♦ Q J 10 7 5
♣ J 6

♠ A Q 6
♥ 8 7 4 3
♦ 8 3
♣ A 10 8 2

West	North	East	South
	1NT	Pass	2♣
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
suit where you hold 8 cards.

In response to partner's Stayman bid you show your 4-card ♠ suit. Partner now bids 2NT.

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Partner had ♥s, not ♠s. His 2NT bid is invitational, 9-10 points, so with 17 points you say 3NT.

North plays 3NT. East leads the ♦Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 4 : ♥ = 0 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 2 :: Total = 8

You need one more winner. Although the ♥K is a possibility, there is a real danger of losing 4 tricks in the suit if East holds the ♥A.

A much better idea is to try to establish a ♣ trick, a

You must give up one ♣ trick in order to establish a winner there. It is important that you give up that ♣ trick to East. West is the Danger hand because if he wins a ♣ he might lead through your precarious ♥K. So win the first trick, enter dummy with a ♠ honor, and play a small ♣, finessing the ♣9 when West plays low.

East wins the ♣J, but you win the game. East cannot profitably play ♥s, so he will probably continue with another ♦. But since the ♣Q will now drop under the ♣ A K you have your ninth trick.

This ♣ holding shows an important principle. As long as the suit splits 3-2 you can establish the fourth card as a winner by ducking one trick.

The key is your ability to choose which defender you want to duck the trick into.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 8 6 2

♥ Q 8

♦ A 8 3

♣ K 5 4 3

♠ Q J 9 7

♥ 10 5 4

♦ J 9 6

♣ Q 9 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 4 3

♥ K 7 3

♦ K Q 2

♣ A 10 7 2

♠ 10 5

♥ A J 9 6 2

♦ 10 7 5 4

♣ J 8

West

North

East

South

2♣

Pass

2♦

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East
= 8

1NT

Pass

With 12 points and a 4-card Major suit you automatically use Stayman; bid 2♣. Partner responds 2♦.

With 12 points and a 4-card Major suit you automatically use Stayman; bid 2♣. Partner responds 2♦.

You have plenty of points for game; with no 4-4 Major suit fit you bid 3NT.

The contract would be 3NT played by West.

East plays 3NT. South leads the ♥6.

First big decision. Which ♥ do you play from dummy?

Winner List: ♠ = 2 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 3 : ♣ = 2 :: Total

The Rule of Eleven tells you there are 5 ♥s in West, North and East which are higher than the ♥6. You and dummy hold 4 of them so you can place North with just 1. The missing high cards are ♥ A J 10 9.

Elementary, Watson; North must hold the ♥10 because from ♥ A J 10 6, ♥ A 10 9 6 or ♥ J 10 9 6 South would **NOT** have led the ♥6. So your first smart move is to play dummy's ♥Q, which holds the trick. What next?

You need to find one more winner and your best chance is the ♣ suit. You will need a 3-2 split in the suit, but you must establish the ♣ winner without letting North get the lead. North is the Danger Hand because he can play a ♥ through your ♥ K 7. Therefore it would be unwise to play ♣A, ♣K, then another ♣ because North is very likely to be the one with 3 ♣s.

Did you get it? Play a small ♣ toward your hand and put on the ♣10 if North plays low. You don't expect the ♣10 to win the trick, it is more of a duck than a finesse. South takes this with his ♣J but he can do you no harm. If he continues with ♥s your ♥K will be a second stopper. If he plays any other suit you will scamper home with your 9 tricks, which of course now include those 3 ♣s.

A duck into the safe hand allowed you to establish the ♣ winner you needed.

But what if North had figured out what you were going to try and played his ♣Q when you led from dummy?

He would have been very, very sorry. You would have had no choice but to win the trick, and when South's ♣J fell on the next trick you would have all 4 ♣ tricks!